

Heather Kemp

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER · DATA SCIENTIST

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Relevant Languages & Skills

Languages C#, Java, C++, Python, JavaScript, Typescript, C, Ruby, Swift, R

Tools Game Development (Unity, UE4, Godot, PlayFab), Continuous Deployment, Databases (Kusto, SQL, Cosmos, Mongo)

Relevant Experience

Microsoft (Xbox and PlayFab Multiplayer and Progression Services)

Redmond, Washington

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

February 2026 - Current

- Modernized the PlayFab Lobby system, ensuring sub-second latency for hundreds of titles against 10,000+ RPS
- Refactored load testing and local testing infrastructure to reduce required resources by 95% and speed up testing by 30%
- Designed configuration analysis pipeline for achievements system, processing 15,000+ games in minutes

Microsoft (PlayFab Monetization)

Redmond, Washington

SOFTWARE ENGINEER 2 · SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

June 2021 - February 2026

- Developed service to provide moderated public access to over 10,000 games' content, seeing over 65,000 RPS
- Refactored purchase flow to support at-purchase and store-wide overrides, allowing for dynamic offer creation
- Performed zero-downtime migration of thousands of live subscription data to stackable subscription model
- Implemented OData search using blob backed projections of catalog items, giving customers cost-effective search options via CDN
- Managed project timelines and workflow for 3 interns, ensuring on-time project delivery
- Improved debugging ability with automated trace and crash dump gathering using dotnet monitor sidecars

Microsoft (Audio Data Intelligence)

Redmond, Washington

SOFTWARE ENGINEER · SOFTWARE ENGINEER 2

June 2019 - June 2021

- Maintained data pipeline and dashboards for xCloud Game Streaming Audio and Input telemetry, allowing meaningful analysis of over 30 million sessions per month
- Trained Machine Learning Classification models and utilized Clustering to triage 70%+ of user feedback with over 80% accuracy

University of Iowa Computer Science Department

Iowa City, Iowa

TEACHING ASSISTANT [PROGRAMMING LANGUAGE CONCEPTS, ROBOT THEATER, ALGORITHMS]

Aug. 2016 - May 2019

- Worked with students daily on individual, small group, and large classroom basis to reinforce various technical learning concepts
- Guided people with varying technical backgrounds on principles of animation and robotics using NAO robots for interactive theater

Relevant Games & Projects

Xbox Adaptive Controller for the Meta Quest (Inclusive Innovation Award 2025)

September 2025 - Current

Developed C++ middleware to record, configure, and playback animations for virtual emulated controllers

Campfire by Games & Online Harassment Hotline (1st Place, Mental Health Hack)

August 2021 - October 2022

Organized team of 5 developers in collaboration with Feminist Frequency to create a UWP app for the Microsoft Store

Game With Your Brain (2nd Place, Gaming for Everyone, OneWeek 2019)

July 2019 - August 2021

Lead team of 7 developers in rapidly prototyping a device that extended the Xbox Adaptive Controller to use brain waves and electronic signals as inputs

Virtual Showdown

December 2018 - July 2019

Refactored and expanded accessible virtual reality game for people with low vision using Unity, Kinect 2.0, and Nintendo Switch SDKs

Bughunters 2

Jan. 2018 - May 2018

Engineered a cooperative virtual reality space exploration and shooter game using Unity and SteamVR in C# and presented at EPXCon

Education

University of Iowa

Iowa City, Iowa

MASTER'S IN COMPUTER SCIENCE (SOFTWARE ENGINEERING TRACK)

Aug. 2017 - May 2019

University of Iowa

Iowa City, Iowa

B.A. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE WITH HONORS AND HIGH DISTINCTION

Aug. 2015 - May 2018

Outreach & Service

2016-Current **Developer and Instructor**, University of Iowa Robot Theater Outreach Program

2019-2021 **R&D Project Lead**, Warfighter Engaged

2016-2019 **Conference Organizer**, EPX Animation and Gaming Conference and UI Computing Conference